

Noise, Feedback, Listening Skills and Grapevine Communication

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Noise

- Noise can be defined as physical sound or mental disturbances that disrupts the flow of communication as the sender or the receiver gets distracted by it.
- According to this definition noise can be classified into two Categories:
 1. Physical
 2. Psychological

Physical Noise

- Physical Noise is that sound which emanates the surroundings and hampers the listening process.
- For example, while speaking on the telephone, disturbances from outside or inside the connectivity may hinder the smooth transmission of message.

Psychological Noise

- It basically takes place due to the unwelcomed ideas or thought in mind
- Ex: Mental Disturbances, Anxiety, Tiredness and Pre-conceived ideas and Notions

Remedies

Types	Causative Factors	Remedies
Physical	Disturbances and distractions in the environment	Ensuring that all channels are clear and free of noise
Psychological	Mental Disturbances, Anxiety, Ego and Prejudices	Entering into Question/Answer Sessions, Securing Advice

Barriers to Communication

- Things which are obstacle to the effective communication process is called Barriers.
- Anything that impedes free flow of ideas
- It can be classified into two categories:
 1. Sender-oriented
 2. Receiver-oriented

Sender-Oriented Barriers

- Sender-oriented Barriers can be Voluntary or involuntary. Some of the Sender-Oriented barriers are as follows:

1. **Badly expressed message:** The sender may not be able to structure ideas accurately and efficiently.

2. **Loss in transmission:** If the choice of channel or medium is not right, the impact of the message is lost.

3. **Semantic problem:** High or big sounding words may hinder the communication process. The problem arises when one can't comprehend the meaning

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4. **Over/Under-communication:** Excess/under information may confuse the audience.

5. **“I” Attitude:** “I” centric individual will not be receptive.

6. **Prejudices:** Starting any piece of communication with a bias or know it all attitude can prove to be quite harmful to the communication process.

How to get rid of it (Remedies)

- Think prior to speaking
- Remove physical noise
- Use simple language
- Minimize usage of “I”
- Formulate messages with open mind.

Receiver-Oriented Barriers

- The receiver too can be guilty of erecting barriers in the course of the interaction.

1. **Poor retention:** If the receiver has poor retention capability, the message will probably get lost in the course of the proceeds. There will be no connection between what was said initially and what is being said now.

2. **Inattentive Listening:** The mind has its own way of functioning. The errors in listening arise because the receiver is either not interested in what is being said or has other things to concentrate on.

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3. **Tendency to evaluate:** Being Judgmental and evaluative can both lead to miscommunication.

4. **Interests and Attitudes:** “I am not interested in what you are saying or my interests lie in other areas”. Starting any piece of communication with this kind of indifference can prevent any attempts at communication.

How to get rid of it (Remedies)

- Jot down points
- Keep the mind open
- Listen to ideas
- Enter into healthy discussions

Feedback

- Response from the receiver is known as feedback.
- This is the most important part of communication that completes the entire process.
- Feedback can be Two types:
 1. Confirmatory
 2. Corrective

Confirmatory Feedback

- Confirmatory feedback determines the moves and actions of the sender. Whatever is being said is accepted and the receiver agrees to the statement.
- The situation is happy in this context and there is no scope for disagreements.

Corrective Feedback

- It is a frequent practice in the field of learning and achievement. It helps to understand one's level of performances.

Listening Skills

- Listening is a process of receiving and interpreting the spoken word.
- It involves recognising what is said and comprehending the matter, i.e., understanding the main and subsidiary points as well as the links between the different parts of speech.
- Effective listening involves not only recognising unit boundaries phonologically, but also the recognition of false starts, pauses, stress, intonation, and rhythm patterns.
- Listening is a process of receiving, interpreting, and reacting to a message received from the speaker.

The Listening Process

- While receiving and interpreting the spoken word, the listener is concerned with four factors.
- Sensing,
- Message decoding or interpreting,
- Evaluating
- Feedback, as illustrated.

Types of Listening

- Listening may be classified into the following six types on the basis of purpose and output:
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- Superficial listening
- Appreciative listening
- Focused listening
- Evaluative listening
- Attentive listening
- Empathetic listening

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- **Superficial listening:** Listening without paying attention. You can hear what the other person is saying, but your attention is somewhere else.
- **Appreciative listening:** The purpose of listening is to derive pleasure. (Rewatching a movie or show only to enjoy)
- **Focused listening:** The purpose is to get some specific information.

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- **Evaluative listening:** The purpose is to evaluate the oral message, commentary and develop a line of thought.
- **Attentive listening:** It is interactive and productive, facilitating proper interaction and more effective listener-speaker relationships.
- **Empathetic listening:** It involves listening to the speaker's feelings, emotions, and state of mind.

Essentials for Good Listening

- Have a receptive mind
- Minimise the distracting factor
- Listen with interest, enthusiasm and maturity
- Control your emotions and listen patiently
- Do not argue or criticise unnecessarily
- Put the speaker at ease by your positive body language

Grapevine Communication

- It is an informal channel of (Internal) communication and it stretches throughout the organization in all directions.
- In spite of the formal (internal) channels of communication in the organization, the informal channel tends to develop because human beings are social animals and they love to interact and therefore it develops.

Characteristics

- It is not controlled by the management
- It emerges from social and personal interactions of the employees
- It follows oral communication
- It begins and ends anywhere in the org
- It is largely used to serve self-interests of those within the organization
- Most of the employees find it believable and reliable
- There's no definite route of it for sharing information.

Transmission



Advantages of Grapevine

- It carries information rapidly. When an employee gets a confidential information, he/she passes the details to his/her close friends and then it starts spreading automatically.
- The managers get the reaction of the subordinates on the company policies. The feedback is quick compared to formal channels of communication.
- It creates a sense of unity among the peers
- It builds up group cohesiveness.
- It serves as an emotional supportive value

Disadvantages of Grapevine

- Carries partial information
- Not at all a reliable/ credible source of communication as it does not follow any official channel of communication
- The productivity of the employees may be hampered as they spend more time in gossip
- Sometimes it creates a hostile environment in the organization

Thank You